patriarchy: women traded like, and in the service of securing, property among men.

Archaeology has shed little light on the practice of caste in Vijayapuri's social life, though modern genetic science has revealed that endogamy in the current population of Andhra Pradesh arose in the first millennium BCE, centuries before Vijayapuri.[21] This was found to be the case for many groups in the region, including today's Vysya caste group, which is about five million people strong. But it's unclear to what extent the early endogamous ancestors of the Vysya were part of a caste *system* this far south. Perhaps, to a large extent, they were. Or perhaps they practised endogamy without caste, as with Ashkenazi Jews, the Amish, and others, and later became a *jati* in the emerging caste system's hierarchy in the region; or perhaps they emerged from an endogamous caste group that had migrated from the north to Andhra lands.[22] Class, however, is apparent enough in the size and density of the housing seen across different parts of Vijayapuri.

As with the Satavahanas, a key legacy of the Ikshvakus is to have advanced into the south both Buddhism and Brahminism, and their associated arts and architectural styles. Both faiths were patronized by the Ikshvaku state but, curiously, the kings leaned strongly towards Brahminism and the queens towards Buddhism. Ikshvaku kings, following their clan tradition, subscribed to Vedic rituals and Puranic worship of Brahminical deities—as evident from inscriptions and the *Ashvamedha* complex inside the citadel, where a sacrificial horse's skeleton was also found. In this, they built upon the royal practices of the Satavahana Empire. What's also amply clear is that Ikshvaku queens played an extremely pivotal role in turning Vijayapuri into a great and famous centre of Buddhism, and presided over the rise of Mahayana. This 'suggests a significant degree of power and authority vested in the women of the royal family, in spite of the fact that succession to the throne remained firmly patrilineal'.[23]